SACOBA
OLD BOYS' ASSOCIATION
ST. ALOYSIUS' COLLEGE

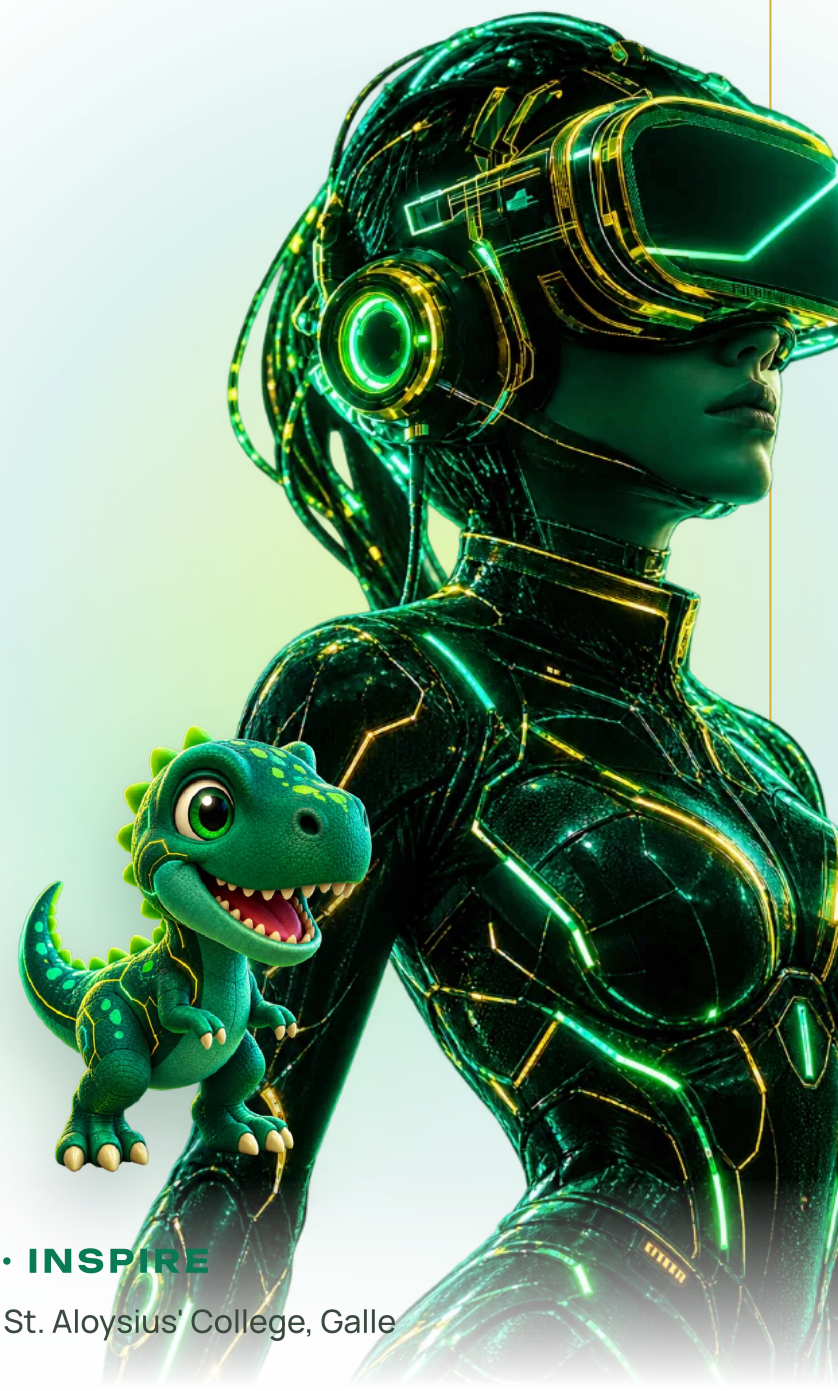
OFFICIAL INVITATION
Official guide for schools

• SACOBA PRESENTS

BYTE QUEST 2027

INNOVATION & HACKATHON

A innovation & technology competition for Sri Lankan school students



LEARN · BUILD · INNOVATE · INSPIRE

Organised by the Old Boys' Association of St. Aloysius' College, Galle

Dear Principal,

On behalf of the Old Boys' Association of St. Aloysius' College, Galle (SACOBA), we cordially invite your school to nominate student teams for **BYTE QUEST 2027 Innovation & Hackathon**.

This guide sets out the competition details, conditions, rules and instructions in full. We kindly request that you share this opportunity with your talented students and extend the support they need to take part.

Yours faithfully,
Organising Committee
BYTE QUEST 2027

01 · INTRODUCTION

Introduction

With the aim of identifying and recognising the innovation, technology and entrepreneurship skills of Sri Lankan school students, the Old Boys' Association of St. Aloysius' College, Galle is organising **BYTE QUEST 2027 Innovation & Hackathon**. The competition will run for four months, from January to April 2027, across four stages.

Throughout the competition, students will also benefit from a lecture series delivered by industry experts and university lecturers. Rather than a traditional one-day event, it is designed as an innovation programme that guides students step by step — from forming an idea through planning, development and testing, to the final presentation.

02 · OBJECTIVES

Objectives

01 Identify talented young innovators and software creators

02 Develop coding, design, AI and problem-solving skills

03 Strengthen teamwork, leadership and communication

04 Encourage technology solutions to community challenges

05 Broaden awareness of the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)

06 Build a national culture of innovation among school students

03 · CATEGORIES

Categories

JUNIOR

Grades 6 – 8

Create a game or application that makes learning fun or solves an everyday problem.

- Education
- Health
- Kindness
- Environment
- Safety
- Sri Lankan Heritage

Scratch · MIT App Inventor

SENIOR

Grades 9 – 13

Innovate for the SDGs Build a technology solution that directly supports one or more of the UN Sustainable Development Goals.

Web · Mobile · Python · AI · IoT · Robotics · Desktop

04 · STAGES

Competition Stages

01	January	**Opening Ceremony** Opening ceremony, confirmation of team registrations and launch of the lecture series.
02	February	**Hackathon 1 · Innovation Challenge** Evaluation of the project idea, problem understanding and initial design.
03	March	**Hackathon 2 · Prototype Challenge** Evaluation of the working prototype and technical progress.
04	April	**Grand Final & Innovation Expo** Final judging, innovation exhibition and awards ceremony.

Exact dates and venues for each stage will be communicated to registered schools.

05 · RULES FOR SCHOOLS

Conditions & Rules — For Schools

01	School registration is open **from 10 November 2026 to 10 January 2027**. Applications received after the deadline will not be accepted.
02	The competition is held in two categories: **Junior** and **Senior**.
03	The Junior category is open to students aged 11 – 13 (Grades 6 – 8).
04	The Senior category is open to students in Grade 9 and above.
05	In special cases, students in Grades 6 – 8 may compete in the Senior category with the written approval of the Organising Committee.
06	Each school may submit one team per category — **a maximum of two teams**.
07	Each team must have **a minimum of three and a maximum of five members**. A student may be a member of only one team.
08	As the competition runs across four stages, **a teacher-in-charge must accompany the students to every stage.** Schools must also **appoint a teacher to coordinate throughout the competition.**
09	Participation requires the **Principal's official approval**.
10	Every competitor must obtain **written consent from a parent or legal guardian**.
11	Teams should combine a range of skills — technical knowledge, public speaking, creativity and logical thinking.
12	The registration form must be submitted with the Principal's signature and official school stamp.
13	The Organising Committee reserves the right to reject registrations with incomplete or false information.
14	All competitors must be current students of the registering school.
15	After registration, team members may be changed only once, before Hackathon 1, with the approval of the Organising Committee.
16	Schools are responsible for students' transport to every stage, and must ensure students' safety and discipline at competition venues.
17	The decisions of the Organising Committee and the Judging Panel on all matters are final.

06 · RULES FOR COMPETITORS

Rules & Instructions for Competitors

A Participation & Conduct

On competition days, teams must arrive and register on time, dressed in school uniform or attire approved by the school.

Competitors must treat judges, resource persons, organisers and fellow competitors with respect.

B The Project

Junior projects must follow the given theme and be built with Scratch or MIT App Inventor.

Every Senior project must directly address one or more SDGs. Projects not aligned to an SDG will not be considered for judging.

Projects must be the team's own original work. Projects previously submitted to, or awarded in, other competitions will not be accepted.

Any open-source code, libraries, images or audio used must be clearly credited and comply with their licence terms.

AI tools may be used as learning aids, but their use must be disclosed in the presentation. Teams must be able to explain their code and solution during the technical interview.

Intellectual property of each project remains with the team. However, organisers may use competitors' names, photographs and project details for promotional purposes.

C On Competition Days

Teams must bring their own laptops, chargers and required devices. Keeping a backup copy of the project and an offline demo is strongly recommended.

All presentations must be delivered **in English only**. A mix of Sinhala and English is permitted in Hackathon 1 only.

Electrical or mechanical components in IoT / Robotics projects must be used safely under the supervision of the teacher-in-charge.

Projects that collect user data must not use personal information without the consent of the individuals concerned.

07 · DISQUALIFICATION

Grounds for Disqualification

The Organising Committee reserves the right to disqualify a team for any of the following:

- Copying others' work or presenting it as one's own.
- The project being developed by teachers, parents or outside professionals.
- Providing false information about age, grade or school.
- Including offensive, hateful, discriminatory or inappropriate content.
- Attempting to improperly influence judges, or disrespectful behaviour.
- Damaging organisers' networks or equipment, or interfering with other teams.

08 · TEACHER IN CHARGE

Responsibilities of the Teacher-in-Charge

	Accompany students to every stage and take responsibility for their safety, discipline and wellbeing.
	Act as the school's official liaison with the Organising Committee.
	Ensure all required submissions for each stage are made before the deadline.
	Offer guidance and encouragement, while ensuring the project is planned and built by the students themselves.

09 · JUDGING

Judging & Grand Final Qualification

Based on combined Hackathon 1 and Hackathon 2 scores, **the top four (4) Junior teams** and **the top five (5) Senior teams** qualify for the Grand Final. All teams receive written feedback after each stage. Each stage is marked out of 100.

Qualification Score = Hackathon 1 × 40% + Hackathon 2 × 60%

JUNIOR

Grades 6 – 8

Hackathon 1 (40%)		Hackathon 2 (60%)		Grand Final (Final)	
Creativity	30	Coding Logic	30	Creativity	25
Problem Solving	25	Creativity	25	Coding Logic	25
Storytelling	20	Presentation	15	Problem Solving	20
Coding Logic Potential	25	User Experience	15	UI Design	15
		Problem Solving	15	Storytelling & Presentation	15

SENIOR

Grades 9 – 13

Hackathon 1 (40%)		Hackathon 2 (60%)		Grand Final (Final)	
SDG Relevance	25	Technical & Business Logic	30	SDG Impact	15
Innovation	25	SDG Impact	25	Technical Excellence	25
Problem Understanding	20	Innovation	20	Innovation	20
Feasibility & UI/UX	30	Presentation	20	Sustainability & Scalability	20
				Presentation	20

10 — AWARDS

Awards & Recognition

JUNIOR

Champion · 1st Runner-up · 2nd Runner-up

- Best Creativity
- Best Coding
- Best Educational Project

SENIOR

Champion · 1st Runner-up · 2nd Runner-up

- Best SDG Impact
- Best Innovation
- Best Technical Solution
- Best Sustainability Project
- Best Presenter

All participants receive a certificate of participation.

11 — CONTACT

Enquiries

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